of less than a year flabbergasting critics who predicted that India would take at least a decade to vaccinate its entire population.

However, at such a time when bets were low on India's ability to survive the pandemic and rampant fear spread unchecked in civil society, one man never lost confidence in our capability to fight the virus and overcome the dark times—the prime minister of India, Narendra Modi. As a once-in-a-century pandemic dawned on us, on his shoulders lay the responsibility of protecting the lives of one-sixth of the world's population, and the broader duty of delivering timely, life-saving, affordable drugs and vaccines to the rest of the world. Many sections of the media greatly attempted to divide the country through the pandemic, successfully creating an environment of extreme partisanship and discord. When societal unison and collective response of the people were paramount in defeating the virus, uniting and securing a dichotomous, vulnerable society became an added challenge for the prime minister. A great part of the public discourse was fissured, with his admirers defending the Indian government's response as against those who seemed perpetually dissatisfied with the establishment. However, in this commotion, as I keenly followed the emerging stories, I was shocked to see how superficial this discourse remained. The gatekeepers of information never really got to the bottom of why India managed to positively surprise the world in its pandemic response. I believe, many others, like me, would like to know the story of how India managed to turn the COVID-19 tide into an opportunity for growth. As you will see through this book, the information that I have put out is based on facts, references and hard data presented in a competitive format with the global response situation. As I inched towards completing the book, my takeaway was clear: we are now in the age of a New India, which is stronger, unflinching in its resolve to grow and undeterred by crises. We are no longer discovering our place in the world, but are confident in our contribution towards humanity and the globe.

This vision was truly ushered in by Prime Minister Modi, from the time he took office in 2014. In simple words, it wouldn't be an overture to say that the reason why India's response to COVID-19 was appropriate, adequate and largely effective was because of the culmination of initiatives that the prime minister introduced from the beginning of his first term up until the pandemic. The bureaucracy and the citizens together responded enthusiastically to his every call. Each time he showed vulnerability,